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DISASTER AFTERMATH

Japan struggles for control

Containment operations suspended at stricken nuclear plant as radiation danger grows. For the latest news, go to InsideBayArea.com.

A Japanese family cooks and eats a meal in front of their damaged house Tuesday, in Ishinomaki, Japan. The population's resiliency is shining through in the wake of last week's disaster. **See story, Page A11.**

AP PHOTOS/KYODO NEWS

Need is great — there and here

TAMMERLIN DRUMMOND
COLUMNIST

IN 1985, a famine in Ethiopia killed 1 million people. Last year, an earthquake in Haiti claimed the lives of at least a quarter-million. Now, a monster earthquake and tsunami in Japan has devastated that nation, killing what will likely run into the tens of thousands of people.

Whenever a tragedy of cataclysmic proportions occurs somewhere in the world, the walls of xenophobia come tumbling down. For a brief moment in time, we set aside racial, cultural, political and religious differences. People across the planet open their hearts and join forces to respond to the mass suffering.

There has been an outpouring of global support for Japan in the aftermath of the horrifying earthquake and tsunami. Hundreds of millions of dollars in aid have been pledged.

Food, clothing, doctors and medical supplies, rescue workers, rescue dogs and military personnel have been sent to Japan from all over the world. Atomic scientists are trying to help contain the nuclear crisis.

It's not just the wealthier countries that have pitched in.

Kandahar is a poor city in

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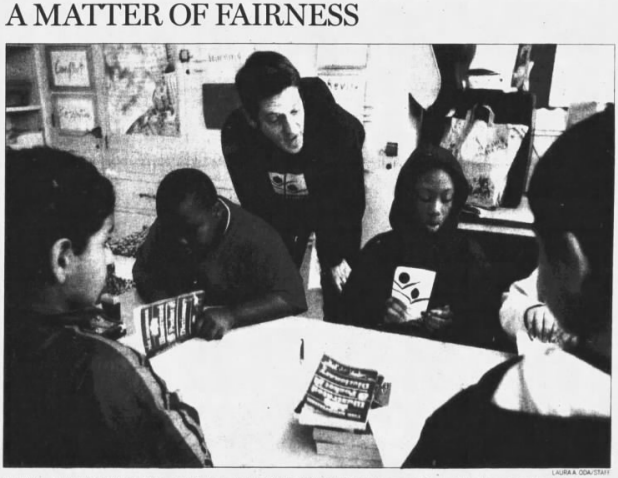
A MATTER OF FAIRNESS



LAURA A. ODA/STAFF

Luc DeArmey helps his Futures Elementary School students Charles Wilson, left, and Averyanna Covin, right, during class Monday in Oakland. DeArmey, a third-year teacher, received a layoff notice. "I think, in the end, the teachers are going to be all right," he says.

Poor schools bear layoff brunt

Campuses in neediest neighborhoods could see teaching staff slashed under 'last-in, first out'

By Katy Murphy
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OAKLAND — The Oakland school district has sent layoff warnings to more than one-fifth of its teaching staff. It was an extreme step, and school officials say they took it to prepare for an extreme budget scenario: the loss of as much as $900 in state funding per student, or $30 million.

The threat of layoffs left few schools in the district untouched, but it hit some much harder than others.

Like most districts, Oakland uses the "last-in, first-out" rule to determine who will keep their jobs in a time of financial uncertainty. This means schools with newer teachers stand to be more deeply affected by layoffs than those staffed by veterans.

No place illustrates this phenomenon more clearly than Futures Elementary, a new school with a 98 percent poverty rate in one of Oakland's most violent neighborhoods.

Principal Steven Daubenspeck said every one of his teachers could be replaced next year — the same teachers who have brought about strong test score gains and a nurturing environment.

"It is a slap in the face of teachers that have worked days and nights and weekends here," he said.

Futures isn't alone.

Daubenspeck said he surveyed principals of 26 schools in East Oakland and learned that 17 of them could lose at least 30 percent of their teachers.

Community United, an elementary school that shares a campus with Futures, could lose 75 percent of its staff, said Monica Moreno, its new principal.

Some teachers say that using years of service as the primary criteria for layoffs is the fairest, most straightforward way to implement the cost-cutting measure.

But others say it's not fair because it harms students in poor neighborhoods the most — those who attend schools with the toughest time recruiting and keeping experienced staff.

See **LAYOFFS**, *Page 11*

INSIDE
Teachers, supporters hold rally at Oakland High School to protest layoffs. **Page A3**

"It is a slap in the face of teachers that have worked days and nights and weekends here."

— Steven Daubenspeck, Futures Elementary School principal

Brown accuses GOP of bullying

Democrats set to vote as Republicans mull measure censuring any in their party a 'traitor' if they approve taxes

By Steven Harmon
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SACRAMENTO — As Gov. Jerry Brown accused "extreme elements" in the Republican party of trying to intimidate GOP legislators from voting to allow his tax extension on the ballot, Democratic legislative leaders announced they will hold a vote Wednesday whether or not an agreement has been reached.

Brown

The votes in the Senate and Assembly are not likely to resolve the central hang-up to Brown's budget proposal: whether Republicans will support Brown's five-year extension of the 2009 tax increases on purchases, income and vehicles.

But they will put legislators on the record for $12.5 billion in budget cuts that were approved last month in committee.

"The governor's proposed budget is the only plan on the table that responsibly and honestly promises to put California's fiscal crisis behind us once and for all," said Senate Leader Darrell Steinberg, D-Sacramento. "It's also a plan that allows Californians to vote on the future of our state. There is no time to waste. Let's vote."

Brown said Tuesday he remains in talks with some Republicans, but that negotiations are being complicated by threats of

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ONLINE
Follow the latest developments in state budget negotiations at InsideBayArea.com/politics-government

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Public pension fund board rejects proposal to reduce investment forecasts

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BEAR TALK: Join our live chat with Cal football coach Jeff Tedford at 3:30 p.m. today at InsideBayArea.com/live-chats.

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L: 30s
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